HCP 1467 - A Pigpen postcard to Adah Thompson

Origin and scope

HC Portal record 1467, catalogue name **pc_hcp_148**, is a privately held postcard dated **13 July 1907**. The portal capture of 26 October 2026 showed Not solved. General, Description and Attachments were inspected; only two scans were attached, with no supplied transcription or solution. The address reads Miss Adah Thompson, Streatham, London; the catalogue spells the surname Thompsson. The picture caption “Miss Hope” is printed matter.

This report covers all **62 handwritten Pigpen letters**. Ordinary address, postmark, printing and ornamental strokes are outside the cipher. One cluster of dots outside the signature glyphs is preserved without assigning it a letter or punctuation function. The writer and the people mentioned remain unidentified; the postmark town has not been securely read.

Source: https://crypto.hcportal.eu/dashboard/cryptograms/1467

Method and key

The message uses interleaved Pigpen: each outline represents an undotted letter and the next alphabetic letter when dotted. Outline names describe the strokes present, relative to the upright working reading.

Outline	Undotted	Dotted
Bottom/right corner	A	B
Bottom/left/right	C	D
Bottom/left corner	E	F
Top/bottom/right	G	H
Four sides	I	J
Top/bottom/left	K	L
Top/right corner	M	N
Top/left/right	O	P
Top/left corner	Q	R
Downward wedge	S	T
Rightward wedge	U	V
Leftward wedge	W	X
Upward wedge	Y	Z

The same table reads all 62 letters. Repeated O, U and the two BOO groups provide internal comparisons; the ordinary English message independently supports the resulting word boundaries.

Literal plaintext

Dots between written words are retained. Spaces and line layout assist reading.

```
HOPE. TO.
SEE. YOU. WITH.
LUCK. SOON. LOOK.
OUT. FOR. THREE.
COUNTRY. YOKELS.
LOVE.
BOO [EXTERNAL DOT CLUSTER] BOO.
```

An editorial sentence reading is: “Hope to see you with luck soon. Look out for three country yokels. Love, Boo Boo.” This does not establish whether the writer is one of the “yokels” or whether Boo Boo identifies a particular person.

Slovak translation: „Pri troche šťastia ťa čoskoro uvidíme. Dávaj pozor na troch vidieckych truhlíkov. S láskou, Boo Boo.“ The plural subject is an interpretive translation; the English opening does not state its subject.

Scan uncertainties

LOVE's third glyph has a dot **inside** the wedge, giving V. In contrast, the signature's dot cluster lies outside the third glyph's O outline. The first O in LOOK has a smudge beyond its lower-right foot, between letters; it is not an internal dot and does not change O to P. These distinctions retain the visible marks without converting stray ink into letters.

Review and correction

Independent review 1 by **Claude Opus 5.5**, dated 26 October 2026, returned REVISE. The reviewer read the scan separately and independently decoded every glyph. It found a single transcription error: the solver had missed the dot in glyph 55 and defended LOUE. The corrected transcript uses dotted >1 and now reads **LOVE** literally. The other 61 glyphs are unchanged. The reviewer explicitly considered a second round unnecessary after this correction.

The response also retained the external signature dots, added the LOOK smudge note, and corrected missing spaces in the documentation. Both decoders now agree on all 62 letters. No published solution was used; no priority claim or historical identification is made.

Reproduction and evidential limits

From the repository root:

```
python3 ciphers/hcp-1467/work/decode.py
```

The command verifies source hashes and decodes the solver's disclosed manual transcription. It is not OCR. The independent review supplies the separate scan collation; successful token roundtrips alone would not prove the reading. Original scans and review files were left unchanged.